

STONED STEEL BATTALION

ARMOR CREW FIELD MANUAL

HELL LET LOOSE: VIETNAM - ENHANCED BLUEPRINT EDITION



PlayStation 5 | Xbox Series X|S | PC

Color key throughout: GREEN = strongest protection / poor target; YELLOW = sensitive or angle-dependent; RED = vulnerable / priority target.

How to Read the Armor Plates

The visual pages have been rebuilt so each vehicle receives its own full page or close-up page instead of squeezing both tanks into a single spread. The diagrams are intentionally large enough to use beside a controller or keyboard.

COLOR	MEANING	CREW ACTION
GREEN	Strongest protection / harder target	Avoid wasting shots here unless the current angle or patch testing proves penetration.
YELLOW	Sensitive / angle-dependent	Viable under the right angle, range or weapon conditions.
RED	Vulnerable / priority area	Preferred target when clearly exposed and current-build testing confirms the hit behavior.

Important: These colored overlays are training visualizations. Exact penetration, armor thickness, ammunition and component behavior can change with patches. Confirm red/yellow/green target behavior in the current game build before treating it as a guaranteed shot.

M48 PATTON - US FORCES



M48 PATTON - ARMOR & WEAK-SPOT CLOSE-UP



Reading the plate: The front turret and upper frontal areas are presented as the strongest zones in green. Yellow marks areas that are more sensitive to angle and shot placement. Red highlights the side hull, lower/rear areas and other vulnerable training targets shown in the reference art.

SSB engagement rule: If your first round fails to penetrate, report the bounce and change the problem - angle, target face, component, or position. Do not repeatedly feed rounds into a proven strong zone.

M48 PATTON - IDENTIFICATION & INTERNAL LAYOUT



Use the exterior views for silhouette recognition from front, side, rear and top. The internal cutaway is a conceptual training aid showing where critical systems and crew spaces are located; it should not be interpreted as a developer-published damage model.

TYPE 59 / T-54 FAMILY - NVA FORCES



TYPE 59 / T-54 - ARMOR & WEAK-SPOT CLOSE-UP



Reading the plate: Green marks the stronger frontal/turret protection depicted by the training diagram. Yellow highlights angle-dependent turret/front areas. Red emphasizes exposed lower, side, track-area and rear targets in the reference art.

SSB engagement rule: Force a better angle rather than challenging the strongest face indefinitely. Track or mobility pressure can create the opening for a flank, while infantry security prevents the enemy crew from doing the same to you.

TYPE 59 / T-54 - IDENTIFICATION & INTERNAL LAYOUT



The low silhouette and rounded turret make quick identification important. As with the M48 cutaway, the internal image is for crew education and target-thinking rather than a promise that the game models every depicted internal module.

SSB Armor Doctrine

- Fight for useful ground, not kill count. Armor protects routes, breaks positions and denies enemy armor.
- Every stop needs an escape plan. Before entering a danger lane, the Commander identifies the reverse route.
- Use infantry as a screen in jungle, villages, river crossings and other close terrain.
- Keep the strongest practical face toward the known threat and minimize exposed side/rear area.
- Withdraw while the tank can still withdraw.

Three-Man Crew

- Commander / Spotter: scans, marks, chooses route, calls targets and owns movement decisions.
- Gunner: confirms ammunition, acquires the target, fires, and reports HIT / BOUNCE / MISS / UNKNOWN.
- Driver: controls gear, hull angle, cover, reverse route and movement on command.

Universal Contact Call

- CONTACT -> target type -> clock/bearing -> approximate distance -> movement -> hull order -> ammunition -> fire authorization.
- Example: "CONTACT ARMOR - 2 O'CLOCK - 300 METERS - MOVING LEFT - HOLD HULL - AP - FIRE WHEN READY."

Driver Field Manual

- Use lower gears for tight turns, obstacles and climbs.
- Approach ridges and dykes so terrain hides as much hull as possible.
- Do not rotate unexpectedly while the Gunner is settling a shot.
- Reverse is a fighting maneuver; preserve the route behind the tank.

Gunner Field Manual

- Keep AP ready when armor is expected and switch to HE deliberately.
- Use impact behavior as information. A bounce means the solution must change.
- Tracks can be a mobility target when a clean kill shot is unavailable.
- Listen to the Commander during reload instead of tunnel-visioning through the optic.

Commander / Spotter

- Scan near flank -> far flank -> front -> likely AT cover -> rear security -> repeat.
- Keep the Driver informed with HOLD, CREEP, FORWARD, REVERSE and PIVOT.
- Coordinate with infantry before entering villages, tree lines, tunnels and bridge approaches.
- Track ammunition and mission value; a surviving tank can reposition and return.

Threat & Terrain Quick Reference

Situation	Primary concern	SSB response
Jungle	Close AT infantry / poor visibility	Infantry screen; avoid unsupported deep pushes; keep reverse route.
Village	Structures conceal rockets/satchels	Infantry clears; tank supports controlled lanes.
Rice paddies	Long sightlines / exposed flank	Use range, marks, dykes and hull-down positions.
Ridge	Overexposure while cresting	Creep; expose only what is needed; reverse after shot if necessary.
Bridge / river	Predictable route / mines / ambush	Recon both ends; secure exit before crossing.
Enemy armor	First-shot advantage	Face threat, AP loaded, Commander marks, Gunner reports impact.
Mines / satchel	Mobility loss or catastrophic close attack	Avoid predictable lanes; move immediately on close threat; call infantry.

Crew Communications

CALL	MEANING
HOLD HULL	Stop hull movement/rotation.
CREEP	Very slow controlled movement.
REVERSE HARD	Immediate maximum practical withdrawal.
ON / VISUAL	Gunner has target.
NO VISUAL	Commander must refine the call.
BOUNCE	Observed non-penetration ricochet behavior.
BREAK CONTACT	Crew disengages instead of continuing the duel.

SSB Armor Qualification

Qualification	Demonstration	Pass / Instructor
Driver I	Gearing, pivot, reverse, obstacle handling, hull-down stop	_____
Gunner I	Shell selection, acquisition, controlled fire, impact report	_____
Commander I	Scan, contact report, marks, route, withdrawal call	_____
Crew II	Three-person engagement without conflicting commands	_____
Tank Commander	All three stations + combined-arms decision making	_____

Patch Verification Log

Before reissuing the handbook after a game update, reproduce the armor behavior in the current build and record the result here. This is where exact ammo counts, penetration behavior, component damage and control changes should be certified.

Date	Build	Vehicle	Item checked	Result	Initials